I

PHQ-4

The Patient Health Questionnaire for Depression and Anxiety [PHQ-4] is a valid ultra-brief tool for detecting both anxiety and depressive disorders.

Questions:
Over the last 2 weeks, how often have you been bothered by the following problems?

1. Feeling nervous, anxious or on edge
    a. Not at all
    b. Several days
    c. More than half the days
    d. Nearly every day
2. Not being able to stop or control worrying
    a. Not at all
    b. Several days
    c. More than half the days
    d. Nearly every day
3. Little interest or pleasure in doing things
    a. Not at all
    b. Several days
    c. More than half the days
    d. Nearly every day
4. Feeling down, depressed or hopeless
    a. Not at all
    b. Several days
    c. More than half the days
    d. Nearly every day

Score: Not at all – 0, Several days – 1, More than half the days – 2, Nearly every day – 3.

Detecting Anxiety using PHQ-4:

1. The score for the questions 1 and 2, should be greater than or equal to three (≥ 3). This score indicates the person is showing signs of anxiety.
2. If the score is ≥ 3 (greater than or equal to 3), it is required to take a more detailed questionnaire on anxiety i.e. GAD-7.

Detecting Depression using PHQ-4:

1. The score for the questions 3 and 4, should be greater than or equal to three (≥ 3). This score indicates the person is showing signs of depression.
2. If the score is ≥ 3 (greater than or equal to 3), it is required to take a more detailed questionnaire on depression i.e. GAD-7.

Overall scoring in PHQ-4:

1. If the person shows signs of both depression and anxiety, based on the above scoring, then

he/she must take both PHQ-9 and GAD-7 questionnaires.

2. If the overall score is < 4 (less than four), self-help is provided by the AI-assistant and asks the person to see a video based on its availability.

II
PHQ-9

Patient Health Questionnaire 9 (PHQ-9) has been identified as the most reliable screening tool for depression.

Primary Questions:
During the past two weeks, have you been bothered by each of the following symptoms

1) Feeling down, depressed, irritable or hopeless
    a) Not at all
    b) Several days
    c) More than half the days
    d) Nearly every day
2) Little interest or pleasure in doing things
    a) Not at all
    b) Several days
    c) More than half the days
    d) Nearly every day
3) Trouble falling asleep, staying asleep, or sleeping too much
    a) Not at all
    b) Several days
    c) More than half the days
    d) Nearly every day
4) Poor appetite, weight loss or overeating
    a) Not at all
    b) Several days
    c) More than half the days
    d) Nearly every day
5) Feeling tired or having little energy
    a) Not at all
    b) Several days
    c) More than half the days
    d) Nearly every day
6) Feeling bad about yourself – or feeling that you are a failure, or that you have let yourself or your family down
    a) Not at all
    b) Several days
    c) More than half the days
    d) Nearly every day
7) Trouble concentrating on things like schoolwork, reading or watching television
    a) Not at all
    b) Several days
    c) More than half the days

    d) Nearly every day
8) Moving or speaking so slowly that other people have noticed? Or the opposite – being so fidgety or restless that you were moving around a lot more than usual
    a) Not at all
    b) Several days
    c) More than half the days
    d) Nearly every day
9) Thoughts that you would be better off dead or hurting yourself in some other way?
    a) Not at all
    b) Several days
    c) More than half the days
    d) Nearly every day

Score: Not at all – 0, Several days – 1, More than half the days – 2, Nearly every day – 3

Follow up Questions:

1. In the past year, have you felt depressed or sad most days even if you felt okay sometimes?
    a. Yes
    b. No

Ask when the score for follow up questions is more than 9.

2. If you are experiencing any of the problems on this form, how difficult have these problems made it for you to do your work, taking care of things at home, or get along with other people?
    a. Not difficult at all
    b. Somewhat difficult
    c. Very difficult
    d. Extremely difficult

Ask when the score for follow up questions is more than 9.

3. Has there been a time in the past month when you have had serious thoughts about ending your life?
    a. Yes
    b. No

Ask when the answer for Question no. 9 (Thoughts that you would be better off dead or hurting yourself in some other way?) in Follow-up question is rated several days, more than half the days or nearly every day.

4. Have you ever, in your whole life, tried to kill yourself or made a suicide attempt?
    a. Yes
    b. No

Ask when the answer for Question no. 9 (Thoughts that you would be better off dead or hurting yourself in some other way?) in Follow-up question is rated several days, more than half the days or nearly every day.

Detecting Major Depressive Disorder using PHQ-9:

1. Questions 1 and 2 in “primary questions” should have a score of 2 or 3.
2. Five or more questions in the entire “primary questions” should have scores of 1 to 3.
3. “If you are experiencing any of the problems on this form, how difficult have these problems made it for you to do your work, taking care of things at home, or get along with other people?” - The answer to this question should be somewhat difficult, very difficult or extremely difficult.

If all three points mentioned have matching scores, then the person is deemed to be suffering from “major depressive disorder”. It is important to ask the person to seek professional help.

Detecting Suicidal tendencies using PHQ-9:

1. Question 9 in “primary questions” is answered with a score of 1 to 3 is considered positive for suicide.
2. Any positive answer for Questions 3 and 4 in “Follow up questions” is considered positive for suicide.

If there is a positive answer for any of the three questions, it is important to ask the person to seek professional help immediately.

Overall Scoring in PHQ-9:

1. If the overall score ranges from 0 to 4 – no or minimal depression. In such cases, AI-assistant must encourage the person to keep up the good work and lead a stress-free life.
2. If the overall score ranges from 5 to 9 – mild depression. In such cases, AI-assistant must encourage the person to follow self-help guidelines to ensure depression doesn’t increase. A self-help is provided by the AI-assistant and asks the person to see a video. Here is the URL: https://rhlaiservice2.blob.core.windows.net/mcare/depression/depression.m3u8
3. Scores above 9 should indicate signs of major depressive disorder and the person is asked to seek professional help as suggested in “Detecting Major Depressive Disorder using PHQ-9".
4. Positive answer for suicide overrides all other scoring options and the person is immediately asked to seek professional help as suggested in “Detecting Suicidal tendencies using PHQ-9". If seeking coping strategies, display the URL: https://rhlaiservice2.blob.core.windows.net/mcare/suicide/suicide.m3u8

Self-help guidelines for depression

(To be provided when the score of PHQ-9 is from 5 to 9)

Depression is a common condition which is like a passing mood or a day of feeling down. It can be managed using the following strategies:

1. Challenge negative thoughts by replacing them with balanced ones. Identify negative thoughts like “I’m worthless” and replace them with balanced ones like “I’m struggling, but that doesn’t mean I’m worthless.

2. Engage in small, meaningful activities like taking a walk, regular exercise, etc.

3. Maintaining a healthy routine (consistent sleep/meals). Go to bed and wake up at the same time daily; avoid screens before bed.

4. Break problems into smaller, manageable parts instead of feeling overwhelmed.

5. Write down 2–3 things you’re thankful for each day.

6. Isolation makes depression worse; connecting with friends, family or support groups helps to lighten your thoughts.

7. Limit the use of alcohol and caffeine.

If you feel that you cannot cope with the symptoms, seek professional help: A doctor, psychologist, or counselor can provide support and treatment options.

Self-help guidelines for suicide
(To be provided no positive answer for suicide but the answers seem suggestive/contemplating suicide)

When suicidal thoughts come, they often feel overwhelming and permanent. However, there are coping strategies that can help you to connect with the present.
1. Ground Yourself in the Present: Use the 5-4-3-2-1 technique (seeing, touching, hearing, smelling, tasting) to reconnect to the here and now when thoughts feel overwhelming.
2. Hold something comforting like a soft object or a pet.
3. A written safety plan can guide you when you're in crisis. It usually includes:
Warning signs: What thoughts, feelings, or behaviors tell me I'm in danger?
Coping strategies: What can I do right now to feel safer (walk, breathe, music, call a friend)?
Safe spaces or distractions: Where can I go or what can I do that feels calming (a park, my room, faith community)?
People I can contact include friend/family, Counselor, Helpline.
Remove or avoid anything that you could use to harm yourself.
4. Reach out immediately to a trusted person (call, text, or write) as isolation fuels suicidal thinking. Send a simple message like, "I'm not okay right now. Can we talk?"
5. Listen to calming music or pray, meditate, or read a meaningful passage.
6. Try challenging hopeless thoughts like "I can't handle this" to "I've handled hard things before, even when I didn't think I could."
7. When you're in crisis, it's easy to forget why life matters. Write a list of things, big or small, that have meaning to you like people who care about you, dreams or goals you haven't yet tried, pets, nature, music, kindness, faith, learning - anything that sparks life. Keep this list somewhere you can reach for it when you feel low.
8. Get Professional Support

III
GAD-7

The Generalized Anxiety Disorder 7-item (GAD-7) is an easy to perform initial screening tool for generalized anxiety disorder.

Questions:
Over the last two weeks, how often have you been bothered by the following problems?

1. Feeling nervous, anxious or on edge
    a. Not at all
    b. Several days
    c. More than half the days

    d. Nearly every day
2. Not being able to stop or control worrying
    a. Not at all
    b. Several days
    c. More than half the days
    d. Nearly every day
3. Worrying too much about different things
    a. Not at all
    b. Several days
    c. More than half the days
    d. Nearly every day
4. Trouble relaxing
    a. Not at all
    b. Several days
    c. More than half the days
    d. Nearly every day
5. Being so restless i.e. hard to sit till
    a. Not at all
    b. Several days
    c. More than half the days
    d. Nearly every day
6. Becoming easily annoyed or irritable
    a. Not at all
    b. Several days
    c. More than half the days
    d. Nearly every day
7. Feeling afraid, as if something awful might happen
    a. Not at all
    b. Several days
    c. More than half the days
    d. Nearly every day

Score: Not at all – 0, Several days – 1, More than half the days – 2, Nearly every day – 3.

GAD-7 total score for the seven questions ranges from 0 to 21.

Overall Scoring in GAD-7:

Score: 0–4 - minimal anxiety
Score: 5–9 - mild anxiety
Score: 10–14 - moderate anxiety
Score: 15–21 - severe anxiety

1. If the overall score ranges from 0 to 4 – no or minimal anxiety. In such cases, AI-assistant must encourage the person to keep up the good work and lead a stress-free life.
2. If the overall score ranges from 5 to 9 – mild anxiety. In such cases, AI-assistant must encourage the person to follow self-help guidelines to ensure anxiety doesn't increase. A self-help is provided by the AI-assistant and asks the person to see a video: https://rhlaiservice2.blob.core.windows.net/mcare/anxiety/Anxiety-coping.m3u8

3. Scores above 9 should indicate signs of anxiety and the person is asked to seek professional help.

Self-help guidelines for anxiety
(To be provided when the score of GAD-7 is from 5 to 9)

Anxiety may sometimes seem random; but there is usually an underlying cause related to genetics, brain function, or co-occurring health conditions. Professional help can assist in uncovering these deeper factors. Symptoms of anxiety can be triggered or worsened by specific factors such as caffeine, certain medications, financial concerns, and stress.

You can identify personal triggers by journaling, therapy, and self-reflection.

Techniques to Help Overcome Anxiety

Effective coping strategies to manage anxiety include:

1**. Grounding**: A technique to feel calm by engaging in your current environment.

- Name 3 things you see.
- Identify 3 sounds you hear.
- Move or touch 3 things (e.g., your limbs or objects).

2. **Breathing Exercises**: Take a deep breath, hold for 2-5 seconds, and then breathe out.

3. **Meditation**: Practice re-centering your body and mind.

4. **Massage**: Helps ease physical tension.

If these techniques are not effective, or for underlying causes, seek professional help from a health care professional.